



OUTREACH & BACKLINK PLAYBOOK · OCTOBER 2026

Spreading the Word

A practical guide to introducing Ochorus to churches, Christian schools, homeschool families and ministries — and earning the website links that help people find it.

1	Ochorus in one page — what we are sharing	2
2	Backlinks, explained simply	3
3	The outreach method: seven steps for every contact	4
4	Working with churches	5
5	Christian schools, colleges and seminaries	6
6	Homeschool families and organizations	7
7	More partners and online link sources	8
8	Ready-to-use message templates	9
9	The 90-day plan, reporting and ground rules	10

SECTION 1

Ochorus in one page

Know what you are offering before you offer it. Everything here is true today and safe to say to anyone.

THE 30-SECOND PITCH

"Ochorus is a free online library of the great Christian classics — books and sermons by writers like Charles Spurgeon, Andrew Murray, John Bunyan and Augustine, plus East African Revival voices such as Festo Kivengere and Janani Luwum. It is free, with no adverts and no sign-up needed, it reads beautifully on a phone, and many works are available in Luganda, Swahili and other languages."

What is in the library

ITEM	COUNT
Classic books (English)	189
Book editions, all languages	600+
Sermons	800+
Authors, with life stories	~100
Languages	10

Languages: English, Luganda, Swahili, Amharic, French, Spanish, Portuguese, Arabic, Hindi and Ukrainian.

Why people say yes

- 1. Free forever.** No adverts, no fees, no login to read.
- 2. Local languages.** 32 works already in Luganda and 65 in Swahili — rare anywhere else online.
- 3. Made for phones.** Comfortable to read on any smartphone, even on slow data.
- 4. Young readers.** Children's and teens' editions of classics such as *The Pilgrim's Progress*.
- 5. Ready for groups.** Daily reading plans, topics and sermon study questions.
- 6. Downloads.** Free PDF and EPUB copies of selected books.

The pages worth sharing

PAGE TYPE	BEST FOR	HOW TO FIND THE LINK
A book	A school reading list, a sermon series	Open the book on ochorus.com and copy the address bar
An author page	Church heritage pages, history lessons	Click the author's name on any book
A reading plan	Small groups, youth fellowships	"Plans" in the site menu
A topic shelf	Prayer, revival, holiness, missions	"Topics" in the site menu
A language edition	Luganda- or Swahili-speaking groups	Switch the site language, then copy the address

GOLDEN RULE

Always share the **most specific page** that fits the person — a book, an author or a plan — not just the home page. Specific links help readers more and count for more with search engines.

SECTION 2

Backlinks, explained simply

A backlink is a link to Ochorus from someone else's website. Each good one is a public recommendation — and Google listens to recommendations.

Why they matter

- 1. Search ranking.** Google treats links from trusted sites as votes of confidence, so Ochorus shows up higher when people search for "Spurgeon sermons" or "Christian books in Luganda".
- 2. Direct visitors.** People click the link and start reading today.
- 3. Trust.** A link from a church or a college tells readers the library is safe and sound.

What makes a link valuable

- 1. Relevance** — a Christian site, a school or a library.
- 2. Trust** — an established organization, a real website people visit.
- 3. Placement** — inside a resource list or article, not hidden in a footer.
- 4. Words** — clear link text such as "free Christian classics in Luganda".

Good links and bad links

GOOD — PLEASE PURSUE

A church's "Resources" or "Recommended reading" page

A college or seminary library guide

A homeschool curriculum blog or co-op website

A news story or blog post about Ochorus

A ministry's training-materials page

A real Christian resource directory

BAD — NEVER PURSUE

Paying anyone to place a link

"Link exchange" deals: we link you, you link us

Comment spam on blogs and forums

Link directories that accept anyone for a fee

Sites about gambling, adult content or loans

Many links from one site's every page (footers, sidebars)

Four words you will hear

WORD

WHAT IT MEANS FOR YOU

Anchor text

The clickable words. Suggest natural ones: "Ochorus free Christian library" or the book's title. Vary them.

Referring domain

A website that links to us. Ten links from ten churches beat ten links from one church.

Deep link

A link to a specific page (a book or author), not the home page. Our favourite kind.

Nofollow

A link that passes less search value (Wikipedia and social media). Still worth having for visitors.

CHECKING A LINK WENT LIVE

Open the partner's page, press **Ctrl+F** (or "Find on page" on a phone), search for "ochorus", click the link to confirm it opens the right page, and record the address in the tracker.

SECTION 3

The outreach method

Use these seven steps for every church, school or website. They turn cold contacts into partners and keep our reputation clean.

1 Find the prospect.

Look for organizations whose readers would love Ochorus: churches, schools, homeschool groups, ministries, Christian bloggers. Use Google, Facebook, denominational directories and your own network.

2 Check the fit.

Is the website active (updated in the last two years)? Does it already link to resources or books? Is it clearly Christian, educational or family-focused? If not, skip it.

3 Find the right person.

The pastor, communications officer, librarian, head teacher or blog author — a named person, not “info@”. A warm introduction through someone you know is best of all.

4 Find the gap.

What would Ochorus add for *them*? A Luganda edition for their members, a free copy of a book on their syllabus, a reading plan for their youth group, a working link to replace a broken one.

5 Make the ask — short and personal.

Under 120 words. Use their name, mention their page, name one specific Ochorus page, and suggest exactly where it could go. Templates are on page 9.

6 Follow up once.

If there is no reply after 7 days, send one polite reminder. After that, let it go and move on — never pester.

7 Record everything.

Log each contact in the shared tracker the same day, including “no” answers. When a link goes live, check it and record its address.

The shared tracker

Keep one spreadsheet (Google Sheets works well) with these columns:

COLUMN	EXAMPLE
Organization & type	St. Andrew’s Church · Church
Website page	The page where our link should go
Contact person & channel	Rev. A. Name · email / WhatsApp / visit
Ochorus page offered	The Luganda edition of <i>Humility</i>
Date contacted · follow-up date	6 Oct · 13 Oct
Status	To contact · Contacted · Replied · Link live · Declined
Link address (when live)	The exact page that now links to Ochorus

REMEMBER

We are offering a gift, not asking a favour. Lead with what helps *their* people; the link follows naturally.

SECTION 4

Working with churches

Churches are our most natural partners: they want their members reading good books, and Ochorus gives them a free library in their own language.

A STORY THAT OPENS DOORS IN UGANDA

Ochorus carries the East African Revival — Simeon Nsibambi, Festo Kivengere, Janani Luwum, William Nagenda and others — alongside the classics. For Anglican and evangelical congregations this is *their own* heritage, freely available. Lead with it.

How to approach a church

- ① **Start with a person you know.**
A member, a youth leader or a choir member can introduce you to the pastor or the communications team. Introductions work far better than cold emails.
- ② **Meet or call, then follow with a message.**
Show Ochorus on your phone in two minutes: open a Luganda or Swahili book, a reading plan, and an author's life story.
- ③ **Offer three ways to use it**
(see the list below), and let them choose.
- ④ **Ask for the website link.**
"Would you add Ochorus to your website's resources page so members can find it?" Offer the exact wording (page 9).
- ⑤ **Thank them and stay in touch.**
Send a new reading plan or a seasonal book every few months.

Ways a church can use Ochorus

- A **"Resources" page link** on the church website
- A **reading plan** for small groups or a fasting season
- A **"book of the month"** announced from the pulpit
- A **QR code** in the bulletin or on a notice board
- Links shared in the church's **WhatsApp** groups and Facebook page
- Sermon study questions for **Bible study** leaders

Who to approach

- **Large city churches** with active websites
- **Diocese and denominational offices** — one link can reach many parishes
- **Churches with founders** on Ochorus: Methodist (Wesley), Baptist (Spurgeon), Salvation Army (the Booths)
- **Youth and campus fellowships**
- **Women's and men's ministries**

TIP

Many church websites have no resources page yet. Offer to help: a short paragraph about Ochorus plus a link is often welcome — and Odyssey's web skills can make that easy for them.

SECTION 5

Christian schools, colleges and seminaries

Links from schools and universities (.ac.ug, .edu and similar) are among the most trusted on the internet. Teachers and librarians link to anything that saves their students money.

Who to approach

- **University and seminary librarians** — they keep online lists of free study resources
- **Lecturers** in church history, theology, missions and Christian ministry
- **Bible colleges** and pastors' training schools
- **Christian secondary schools** — chaplains and Christian Religious Education teachers
- **Christian student unions** on campus

What to offer them

- **Free primary sources:** Augustine, Athanasius, Luther, Calvin, Wesley and more, readable on a phone
- **Reading lists** by subject: early church, Reformation, revival, missions, African Christianity
- **African voices:** Samuel Ajayi Crowther and the East African Revival
- **Downloads** students can keep for offline study

Step by step

- ① **Find the library's online resource pages.**
Search: "[college name] library e-resources" or "[college name] theology free resources". Note pages that already list free websites.
- ② **Find the course outlines.**
Which classic texts appear on theology or history reading lists? Check that Ochorus has them.
- ③ **Write to the librarian or lecturer by name.**
Say which course or page it helps, and include direct links to the exact books.
- ④ **Offer a short demo**
for staff or students — 15 minutes in a library session or a chapel announcement.
- ⑤ **Ask for a place on the resources page**
and the course reading list. Thank them, then check and record the link.

TIMING MATTERS

Reading lists are written **before each term or semester begins**. Contact lecturers and librarians 4–6 weeks before the term starts, when they are choosing materials.

TIP

Ask international contacts too. Seminaries in Kenya, Tanzania, Nigeria, the UK and the USA keep the same kind of library guides. One well-placed email to a librarian can earn a link that other libraries copy.

SECTION 6

Homeschool families and organizations

Christian homeschoolers love the classics and are always looking for free, wholesome books. They also blog and share generously — which makes them excellent sources of links.

What makes Ochorus a good fit

- 1. Classic literature for every age.** Children's and teens' editions of works like *The Pilgrim's Progress*, plus the full originals for older students.
- 2. Free and ad-free** — safe for children to use.
- 3. Life stories** of missionaries and preachers for history and character lessons.
- 4. Daily reading plans** that fit a school-day rhythm.

Who to approach

GROUP	WHERE TO FIND THEM	WHAT TO ASK FOR
Homeschool associations & co-ops	National association websites, Facebook groups	A spot on their "free resources" page or newsletter
Curriculum bloggers	Search: "Christian homeschool free books", "classical education reading list"	A mention in a reading-list post
Charlotte Mason & classical communities	Blogs, forums and podcasts on "living books"	A link beside the classics they recommend
Christian parenting sites	Family ministries and magazines	A short guest article on reading the classics with children
Local families	Churches, school networks, WhatsApp groups	Share it and tell friends; feedback for us

Step by step

- 1 Search for existing "free books" lists**
on homeschool sites (search strings above). These pages exist to link out.
- 2 Read the list first.**
Note which books they recommend that Ochorus offers free, or in another language.
- 3 Write a friendly note**
naming their list and one or two specific Ochorus books that would fit it.
- 4 Offer something extra.**
A short guest post such as "*Five Christian classics to read aloud with your children.*" A guest post with a link is often easier to say yes to than a bare link.

TIP

Homeschool audiences are worldwide and mostly in English. Pitch the children's editions and missionary biographies first — they are the easiest "yes".

SECTION 7

More partners and online link sources

Beyond churches and schools, these partners and methods each bring links, readers or both.

PARTNER	WHY THEY CARE	WHAT TO ASK FOR
Mission agencies & ministries	Need training material in local languages	A link on their resources or training page
Christian radio & TV	Need content and listener resources	An on-air mention; a link on the station website
Christian bloggers & podcasters	Always need something useful to share	A review, a mention, or a guest post
Christian bookshops	Customers who cannot afford every book	A poster or QR code; a link on their site
Tech & startup media	A Ugandan team supporting a free reading app is a good story	A short feature or interview

Three online methods

1. Fix broken links (our highest success rate)

1. Find old Christian websites that have shut down (pages now showing “Page not found”).
2. Use a backlink checker tool to list the pages that still link to them.
3. Where we host the same book, write: “Your link to [book] is broken — here is a free working copy.”

This works because we are fixing a real problem for the website owner. Expect a much higher reply rate than ordinary outreach.

2. Resource pages

Search Google for pages that list free Christian books, for example “free Christian classics online”, “Spurgeon sermons free” or “vitabu vya Kikristo bure”. Point out what is missing from their list — usually a language or a book they do not have — and offer our page.

3. Directories and app listings

Submit Ochorus to genuine, human-curated Christian resource directories and app review sites. Use the same short description each time. Skip any directory that charges for a listing.

WIKIPEDIA: PLEASE LEAVE THIS TO US

Wikipedia has strict rules about people promoting their own websites, and breaking them can get Ochorus blocked. Please **do not add Ochorus links to Wikipedia**. If you spot a Wikipedia article where Ochorus would genuinely help, note it in the tracker and we will handle it.

SECTION 8

Ready-to-use message templates

Replace every *[bracketed]* part. Keep it short, personal and specific — never send the same message unchanged to many people.

A · CHURCH (EMAIL OR WHATSAPP)

Dear [Pastor name],

I'm [your name] from Odyssey Technologies. We're helping share Ochorus, a free online library of Christian classics with no adverts or sign-up — including [the East African Revival voices / books in Luganda].

I thought your members might enjoy [book or reading plan + link]. Would you consider adding Ochorus to [your website's resources page]? I'm happy to send a short description to paste in.

Blessings, [name, phone]

B · LIBRARIAN OR LECTURER

Dear [Name], I noticed your [library guide / course page] lists free study resources. Ochorus offers free, phone-friendly editions of [Augustine's Confessions, etc. + links], no login needed. Would it be useful to add it to that page for your students? Thank you for your work, [name].

C · HOMESCHOOL BLOGGER OR ASSOCIATION

Hi [Name], I enjoyed your post [post title]. You might like Ochorus: free, ad-free Christian classics, including children's editions of [book + link]. It could fit nicely in your list of [topic]. I'd also be glad to write a short guest post if that helps. Thank you! [name]

D · BROKEN LINK

Hello [Name], on your page [page address], the link to [book title] no longer works. There's a free, ad-free copy here: [Ochorus link], in case you'd like to update it. Kind regards, [name]

E · DESCRIPTION THEY CAN PASTE ON THEIR WEBSITE

Ochorus — free Christian classics. Read hundreds of classic Christian books and sermons by Spurgeon, Murray, Bunyan, Augustine and East African Revival leaders, free and without adverts, in English, Luganda, Swahili and more. [link: <https://ochorus.com>]

F · ONE POLITE FOLLOW-UP (AFTER 7 DAYS)

Hi [Name], just a gentle follow-up on my note about Ochorus. No pressure at all — if it would help your [members / students / readers], I'm happy to send anything you need. Thank you, [name]

SECTION 9

The 90-day plan, reporting and ground rules

A steady weekly rhythm beats a big burst. Aim for quality: one link from a real church beats ten from nowhere.

WEEKS	FOCUS	GOAL BY THE END
1-2	Set up the tracker; build a list of 100 prospects; learn the site; directory listings	100 prospects listed; 10 listings submitted
3-6	Churches and Ugandan schools; broken-link and resource-page outreach begins	60 contacts made; first 15 links live
7-10	Seminaries abroad, homeschool groups, bloggers, radio; follow-ups	150 contacts total; 40 links live
11-13	Double down on whatever is working best; thank partners	60+ links live; a short lessons-learned report

Weekly rhythm

- 1. Monday** — find 20 new prospects
- 2. Tue-Thu** — send 15-20 personal messages; make 2-3 visits or calls
- 3. Friday** — follow-ups, check live links, update the tracker, send the weekly report

Weekly report (5 lines)

- ☐ Contacts made this week
- ☐ Replies received
- ☐ New links live (with addresses)
- ☐ Best conversation or lesson
- ☐ Help needed from Ochorus

Ground rules

- ✗ Never pay for a link or accept payment for one
- ✗ No link swaps, spam comments or mass emails
- ✗ Do not add links to Wikipedia — flag them to us
- ✗ Never promise features Ochorus does not have
- ✗ Do not describe how books were translated; just share the book
- ✗ Be honest that you are helping Ochorus
- ✗ Respect a “no” — one follow-up only

CONTACTS

Ochorus contact: _____ Email / WhatsApp: _____

Odyssey lead: _____ Shared tracker link: _____

Thank you for helping more people discover these books. Every link is a doorway for someone to read words that have strengthened believers for centuries.